A REGIONAL INNOVATION PROGRAM FOR ASEAN YOUTHS

Theme: **AI for a Resilient ASEAN: Innovation, Sustainability, and Humanity**

Hosted by: ASEAN AI Council | **Co-hosted by:** Duy Tan University

Supported by: Passage to ASEAN (P2A)

I. VISION & STRATEGIC OBJECTIVES

As Southeast Asia's digital economy is projected to exceed **USD 1 trillion by 2030**, the demand for industry-ready AI talent has never been more urgent. The **ASEAN AI Hackathon 2026** serves as a high-impact **industry-academic bridge**, connecting top student innovators from the **P2A network** with technology leaders to co-create ethical, real-world AI solutions.

By integrating mentorship and deployment opportunities, the program transforms student potential into workforce readiness with five core objectives:

- **Future-Ready Competencies:** Building advanced AI, Cloud, and Agile skills to bridge the gap between classroom learning and the global job market.
- **Human-Centric Innovation:** Leveraging AI (ML, NLP, CV) to create solutions that prioritize regional progress and human well-being.
- **Regional Resilience:** Architecting scalable and sustainable AI applications tailored to solve ASEAN's unique challenges in health, climate, and education.
- **Transnational Ecosystem:** Fostering a "One ASEAN" spirit through cross-cultural collaboration across the 11 member states.

II. GENERAL INFORMATION

1. **Schedule:** March – July
2. **Platform:** Hybrid Mode (Online workshops/mentoring via Zoom; On-site Final Pitching in Vietnam)
3. **Participation:** Open to students from ASEAN Institutions.

- **Number of teams per Institution:** 2-5 teams.
- **Team Structure:** 3 to 5 members per team.
  - **Multidisciplinary:** Must combine Technical students (IT/AI) and Non-technical students (Business/Social Sciences) to ensure viable business models and social impact.
  - **Gender Balance:** Strongly encourage female leadership
  - **Top 8 Finalist Teams:** Opportunity travel to Da Nang, Vietnam for the Grand Finale.

III. SCOPE AND FOCUS AREAS: Four main challenge tracks:

(1) **Climate Change Resilience:** Focuses on disaster mitigation, emergency response, and addressing the impacts of climate change, especially in underdeveloped regions

(2) **Public Health & Telemedicine:** Digital health systems and women's healthcare advancements.

(3) **Smart City:** Include Mobility & Urban Sustainability. Intelligent transportation, urban digital transformation, and sustainable living.

(4) **AI for Education:** Focuses on applying AI across all levels of education to enhance learning experiences and equal opportunities.

IV. PROPOSED SCHEDULE (subjects to change)

4.1 Competition Structure

- **Registration & Abstract:** Teams register and submit a 1-page Project Abstract.
- **Intensive Workshops:** All teams attend Workshops 1, 2, & 3 to build their AI foundation.
- **Draft Submission & Top 20 selection:** Teams submit preliminary projects. Mentors select the Top 5 teams per track (20 teams total).
- **Mentorship & Finalization:** The Top 20 undergo Workshop 4 & 1-on-1 coaching to refine their prototypes.
- **Virtual Semi-Final:** Top 20 teams pitch virtually. Judges select the Top 2 teams per track (8 finalists total).
- **Grand Finale:** The Top 8 Finalists are sponsored to travel to Da Nang, Vietnam for the live final pitch at the ASEAN AI Summit.

4.2 Tentative Schedule (subjects to change)

Timeline	Activity	Actions
ROUND 1: Registration & Abstract Submission		
Now - April 12	**Registration & Abstract Submission**	• **Entry Submission:** Institutions submit Team lists (3 - 5 members/team) + Abstract. • Assign mentor for each team ENTRY FORM | AAIH 2026
ROUND 2: Launch & Workshops		
April 23	**Opening Ceremony & Workshops 1+2** **Via Zoom Meeting**	• **Morning:** ○ **Opening Ceremony** ○ Workshop 1: **Human-Centric AI & Regional Problem Solving**

	(6 hours)	• **Afternoon:** Workshop 2: **Technical Architecture & Data Ethics**
May 5	**Workshops 3** **Via Zoom Meeting** (3 hours)	• Workshop 3: **Agile Prototyping & Technical Execution**
May 17	**Draft Submission**	**Preliminary Project Submission:** Detailed project abstract + initial technical roadmap.
May 16 - 24	**Grading**	TC Mentors grade submissions to select **Top 20 Teams**
May 26	**Top 20 Announcement**	**Top 20 Announcement**: 5 teams per track selected for Mentorship.
ROUND 3: Mentorship & Semi-Finals		
June 02	**Workshop 4** **Via Zoom Meeting**	Workshop 4: **The Innovation Pitch & Scalability** **Deep-Dive Coaching:** Top 20 teams work with TC mentors to finalize prototypes and videos.
June 03 - 20	**Project Finalization**	Refining prototypes and AI model accuracy based on TC mentorship.
June 25	**Semi-Final (Virtual)** **Via Zoom Meeting**	• **Recording Virtual Pitching:** 5-minute presentation + 3-minute Q&A. • Top 20 submit Recording Pitching Video • Mentors grade submissions
Jun 30	**Finalists Reveal**	• Top 8 Announcement • Prepare **Product Promotion Video** (1-1.5 min) • Prepare to travel to Danang, Vietnam.
July 5	**Promotion Video Submission**	Top 8 teams submit Video Promotion for **Online Voting**
Jul 6-12	**Online Voting**	Online Voting on Social Media Channel
ROUND 4: Grand Finale		

Jul 31	**On-site Event at DTU**	• **Finalists:** Travel to Danang and Join the **ASEAN AI Summit 2026**. • Final Live Pitch during the ASEAN AI Summit.

V. PROJECT EXPECTATION: THE AI INNOVATION PORTFOLIO

Teams are expected to deliver a comprehensive **AI Innovation Portfolio**.This portfolio proves that the solution is technically robust, ethically designed, and ready for real-world application.

5.1. Core Outputs: Teams must submit the following mandatory components through the stages:

Due Date	Output	Format	Key Content Requirements
May 17	**1. Technical Roadmap (Draft)**	PDF (2-3 pages)	Initial problem-solution fit, proposed AI tools, and development timeline.
June 25	**2. Final Technical Pitch Deck**	PDF (Max 15 Slides)	• Problem-Solution Fit & Market Research • AI Architecture (Models & Tools used) • Data Strategy & Ethical Framework • Scalability Roadmap for ASEAN
June 25	**3. Code Repository & Prototype**	GitHub Link + Demo URL	• Clean, documented Source Code • Functional Prototype (Web/App/PoC) • Video screen-cast of the AI in action
June 25	**4. Semi-Final Presentation Video**	MP4 (Max 5 Mins)	A deep-dive recording covering: • Live Prototype demonstration • Technical hurdle breakdown • Explanation of Model accuracy/efficiency
July 05	**5. Product Promotion Video**	MP4 (1-1.5 Mins)	High-impact video for **Online Voting**. Focused on storytelling, user impact, and "The Big Idea."

5.2 Technical Submission Guidelines

- **Originality:** Work must be original. Use of external models (OpenAI, HuggingFace) is allowed but must be cited in the Pitch Deck.
- **Data Ethics:** Use only licensed or public datasets. Briefly explain how you address AI bias in your submission.

- **Video Specs:** 1080p (16:9 Landscape), English voiceover, and royalty-free music (to avoid copyright issues).
- **Accessibility:** All links (GitHub, Demo URL, Video) must be PUBLIC. Private or restricted-access links will lead to immediate disqualification.
- **Documentation:** GitHub repositories should include a basic README file with setup instructions.

5.3. Evaluation Criteria

- **Innovation & Originality (25%)**: Uniqueness of the AI application.
- **Technical Execution (30%)**: Complexity, robustness of the code, & effective use of AI tools.
- **Impact & Feasibility (30%)**: Potential to solve real-world ASEAN problems and scalability.
- **Presentation & Demo (15%)**: Quality of the pitch and functionality of the prototype.

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